The Violinist's Ballad

Carina Grady

A playful little thing, that perfect violin.
How delightful, how charming!
Its delicate scroll, its swaying bow
Perfected to perform.

Take a bow, now,
It is time to come of age.
Imagine the fame you could claim
Before we walk backstage.

Rest your chin on me, darling,
As I pluck your strings and watch them wriggle.
Sing the tune of your melody, darling,
As I touch the curves of your fiddle.
Full-bodied and warm
Racy fingers press into the neck.
Hold your breath, follow the score
Those sweet fingerings, I adore.

Two holes shaped fatefully as an *f*
Where the violin does ring.

Romantic, it sounds,
How lovely,
How deep.

Until it shrieks—
How awful,
How weak.

Violent is the song that
Fragments the muse.

Crack—

Splinter,
Sinister.

How sad,
What a waste,
Such a pretty little thing.